OPEN LETTER · STEVE PROTHERO · OWNER

Greenway Terraces: reduced-quorum AGMs since 2020 and unanswered correspondence

Sent 13 October 2026 · To The Executive Committee, Greenway Terraces (UP12457) · Response requested by 10 November 2026

13 October 2026

The Owners Corporation, Units Plan 12457 – Greenway Terraces
The Secretary, Executive Committee
c/- Grady Strata and Facilities

Covering note: brief on participation, the Committee, and the handling of resident correspondence

Dear Committee members,
I attach a brief for the Executive Committee and the communication group. It sets out what the minutes show about who takes part in Owners Corporation decisions, poses a question about how the Committee is perceived, and proposes ways of testing it, including a review of how resident correspondence has been handled.
The starting point.
Under the Unit Titles (Management) Act 2011, the functions of the Owners Corporation belong to the owners as a body (section 16).
The Executive Committee is the administrative mechanism through which those functions are exercised (section 35(1)), and it must exercise them as the Owners Corporation directs by resolution at a general meeting (section 35(3)).
The direction of the complex is therefore for owners to set, and to set it they need to be fully engaged:
informed before decisions are made,
able to contribute, and
able to vote without having to attend in person.
The priorities below are proposed on that basis.
What I am unclear about
I am unclear what the communication group is intended to do. I have not seen its terms of reference. I would be grateful if the Committee could confirm the following four matters:
1. its remit, and whether it advises the Committee or communicates on the Committee's behalf;
2. its membership, including whether owners outside the Committee and residents who rent are involved;
3. who it reports to, and what authority it has to act; and
4. its timetable, including when its first outputs are due and when it will report to owners.
Suggested priorities

So that the group has concrete work, I suggest three priorities, in this order.

1. Consultation ahead of the AGM. Make the draft motions, the budget and a plain-English explanation of each item available to owners before the notice issues, with a set period for questions and published answers. Announce the dates for nominations and owner motions early. The reason is that every general meeting since 2020 has run as a reduced-quorum meeting, with between 26% and 44% of lots represented, and the minutes record a vote count for only one of 106 motions. Consultation lets more owners shape a motion before the meeting.

2. Input from owners and residents. Provide one visible route for ideas and questions from owners and residents, including those who rent. Each item would be acknowledged within a stated number of working days, given a named owner, answered with reasons, and listed in the Committee minutes until closed. (See my earlier comments about where I think the minutes need to be improved)

3. A form of electronic voting. Owners resolved at the 2021 AGM (Motion 20) to allow electronic voting, including pre-meeting voting, under section 10 of the Unit Titles (Management) Regulation 2011. The 2025 and 2026 notices offer attendance, proxy and absentee papers but not pre-meeting electronic voting. Elections are excluded from pre-meeting voting and would stay at the meeting. Turnout peaked at 66 lots in 2025, when 21 absentee forms were lodged. A first step is to ask Grady Strata what it needs, at what cost and by what date, and to trial it at the next general meeting alongside absentee and proxy voting.

The order matters: consultation and input give owners something to respond to, and electronic voting makes responding easier.

What I ask

• That the brief be tabled at the next Committee meeting, and the four matters above confirmed.

• That the Committee state which of the three priorities it will adopt, and by when.

Yours sincerely,

Steven Prothero

Owner, Lot 151

GREENWAY TERRACES – UNITS PLAN 12457

Brief for the communication group: participation, the Committee, and how resident correspondence was handled

Prepared by Steven Prothero (Lot 151) | For the Executive Committee and the communication group | 13 October 2026

1. Purpose and question

This brief sets out what the records show about who takes part in Greenway Terraces decisions, and proposes how the new communication group could test a question that has

been raised: is there a perception among owners and residents that a small group of long-standing owners holds the Committee, and if so, is it accurate and what contributes to it?

There are three separate parts to that question. The records do not capture the perception itself, because nothing asks owners what they think. Whether it is accurate can be partly tested from the minutes. What contributes to it needs a few further records, a short survey, and a review of how resident correspondence has been handled (section 5).

No record holds anyone's age, so tenure (how long a lot has been represented at meetings or on the Committee) is used as the measurable stand-in. Age should only be asked about voluntarily and anonymously.

Author's interest: the author was a nominee at the 2026 AGM and is the sender of the correspondence summarised in section 4. The figures and framing should be checked independently before this brief is used further.

2. What the records show

Who sits on the Committee

Title: Committee seats and AGM attendance - Description: Committee seats by lot 2020-2026 and lots represented at each AGM

- 19 lots have held a seat across seven terms (13% of lots). Lot 124 has held one in every term, Lot 150 in six, and Lots 16 and 28 in each of the five since 2022.
- The 2023 and 2024 committees were the same five lots (14, 16, 28, 124 and 150). The Committee returned to seven in 2025.
- In 2026 six of the seven seats went to lots on the 2025 committee. The seventh (Lot 4) is new to the Committee but has been recorded at AGMs since 2020. All seven lots were represented at the first AGM in November 2020, although Lot 107 by a different person.
- No election is recorded before 2026. Each committee was appointed by one motion naming the people, and the minutes do not record how many nominated. In 2026 a motion from the floor to appoint eleven failed and a motion to appoint seven carried (Motions 14 and 15). The minutes give no counts or rounds.

Recruitment over time

The first AGM (November 2020) elected twelve. Difficulty in filling seats appears later: a vacancy recorded in December 2022 as "will not be filled"; three resignations in six weeks in April and May 2023; a reduction from nine to five members in August 2023; and eight resignations in six years. The number of nominations in each year before 2026 is not recorded, so a view that it was hard to find candidates is consistent with the record but not shown by it. The nomination forms held by the manager would settle it.

Who attends

- Between 26% and 44% of lots are represented at an AGM. 37 lots attended five or more of the seven, 46 have never been recorded, and no meeting has reached the standard quorum

of 76.
• The 2026 room was larger and more familiar. 48 lots attended in person, the most since 2020 (55). 44 lots carried over from 2025, the highest carry-over of any year, and 5 lots were new to the record (4 of them in person: Lots 46, 77, 103 and 121). Of the 14 first-timers in 2025, 3 returned.
• It was broader than in 2023 and 2024 but not newer. Lots outside the regular group made up 38% of the in-person room in 2026 (18 of 48), against 28% to 29% in 2023 and 2024 and 43% in 2025. Interest in seats did not appear as a surge of new lots.
• Committee lots are consistently present. Every committee lot has been represented at every AGM since 2023.
Why 2026 differed: possible reasons, none yet tested
• Higher stakes. The 2026 AGM carried defects-remediation contracts and special purpose funds (including $80,000 for electrical infrastructure) and approved the concept of perimeter fencing and gates.
• A visible vacancy. The Treasurer resigned in March 2026.
• More public discussion. Through 2026 residents raised pool, playground, security and governance questions by email and on Facebook. The author was among those writing.
• A stronger base after 2025. In-person attendance rose from 35 (2024) to 44 (2025) to 48 (2026), and the 2026 meeting offered Teams.
• Nominations on the night. Motion 14 was raised from the floor, which suggests some nominations arrived at the meeting. Whether any came in advance through Grady Strata is not recorded.
3. What the records cannot show
• Age, length of ownership, and whether a lot is owner-occupied or investor-owned.
• Anything about renters, who do not appear in the voting record.
• Language or cultural background. It should not be inferred from names.
• Nominations before 2026, and the 2026 count for each candidate.
• Why people do or do not stand. The analysis covers seven AGMs and not special general meetings.
4. Correspondence with Grady Strata and the Committee before the 2026 AGM
The source is the author's own email records, compiled in a register dated 31 August 2026. It is one party's record. It will not capture anything handled by phone or in person, and the Committee's account is not in it.

• Volume. Between 13 December 2025 and 17 August 2026 the author sent about 45 distinct items to Grady Strata and Committee members. Most concerned the pool, playground, gardens, cameras, minutes and spending.
• Written replies. Six replies are recorded between 28 February and 21 March 2026, mostly acknowledgements and attached responses. No written reply is held after 21 March, up to 31 August. Circulars and minutes to all residents continued throughout.
Items bearing on participation and membership:

• 17 March – a letter to Grady Strata and the Committee on Committee membership: governance, spending transparency, resident engagement and willingness to fill the vacancy. The Secretary acknowledged it on 18 March, stating that the Committee would discuss it at its next meeting and forward a response. No response is recorded.
• 15 and 17 April – questions on reducing problems with new tenants, and on the "welcome pack".
• 7 May – a question about absentee voting for the special meeting.
• 15 July – a request, through Grady Strata and for circulation to all Committee members, for an explanation of the Committee's engagement with members, including that outstanding correspondence be answered.
• Before the AGM – electronic voting was raised, and the reply, in substance, was that it was a matter for the incoming Committee to work on.
• After the AGM – the position put in writing was that no response could be made until an approved committee was in place, which would not occur until 28 days after the AGM.
The exact wording and dates of the two "incoming committee" statements are not held in the project papers. Insert them from the original emails before this is circulated beyond the Committee.

These statements create a checkable record. If no petition was lodged and the notice of reduced quorum decisions was given (neither is in the author's records), the 28 days from the 26 August AGM ended on 23 September. The incoming Committee has had time to meet. The factual questions are whether the referred items were listed, whether the correspondence register was tabled, and whether electronic voting was discussed. The Committee may have answers that are not yet in the record.

5. Proposed review: how was resident correspondence handled?
The communication group could review resident correspondence received in a defined period, and assess how each matter was handled against recognised communication practice. The purpose is to learn what works and what could be improved, not to apportion fault.

What good practice is
In short: a message is acknowledged promptly, has one named owner, is answered on its substance with reasons in plain language within a stated time, is recorded, and is closed or carried forward with a date. The yardsticks below come from complaint-handling and engagement guidance. They were written for public agencies and businesses, and none is binding on an owners corporation, so they are used as a reasonable benchmark and not as a legal test.

The criteria
1. Acknowledged. Receipt confirmed, with a contact person, next step and expected timeframe, ideally within 3 business days. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Effective Complaint

Management Guidelines (Principle 3 and section 9.2), citing AS 10002:2022. Test: the dates of receipt and acknowledgement.
2. Owned. One named person or role is responsible, and the sender is told who. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 4. Test: whether a responsible person is identifiable in the record.
3. Timely. A timeframe is stated, kept, or replaced by a dated update if it slips. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 5.For reference, one agency publishes 5 business days to acknowledge and 20 business days for most substantive responses (IPART policy). Those are an example of a published target, not a standard. Test: stated date against actual reply date.
4. Answers what was asked. Each question is addressed, and a refusal says so. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 3 (tell people the outcome and the reason). Test: a line-by-line match of questions to answers.
5. Gives reasons. The outcome is explained, with the authority relied on (the Act, the rules, a resolution) where relevant. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 3; Unit Titles (Management) Act 2011, Schedule 1, Part 1.1 (honesty and fairness, care and diligence, acting in the owners corporation's best interests) and Part 1.2 for managers. Test:whether the reasons are stated and traceable.
6. Plain language. Short sentences, defined terms, and a structure a non-expert can follow. Source: Australian Government Style Manual. Test: a reading check by someone outside the Committee, and whether translation was offered where needed.
7. Respectful, without detriment. Courteous in both directions, and no adverse treatment for raising a matter. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 1. Test: tone of the record, assessed against a checklist and not by impression.
8. Recorded. The item is logged with a reference, dates and outcome, and appears in the minutes under a standing "correspondence received and responses due" item. Source: NSW Ombudsman, record keeping (sections 8 and 9.3); the Act makes answering correspondence a function of the secretary (section 42), though it sets no deadline. Test:whether a complete log and minute entry exist.
9. Closed or carried forward. Each item is answered, closed with reasons, or listed on a forward agenda with a date. Test: the status of each item at the review date.
10. Shared and learned from. Answers of general interest are shared with all owners, and patterns are reviewed. Source: NSW Ombudsman, Principle 6 (transparency) and section 8 (learning). Test: whether a theme report or a general notice followed.
11. Level of engagement matched. For matters affecting many residents, the Committee states whether it is informing, consulting or involving them, and keeps that promise. Source: IAP2 Spectrum of Public Participation (inform, consult, involve, collaborate, empower). Test: whether the stated level was kept.
How it is judged
• Rate each item on each criterion as Met, Partly met, Not met, Not applicable, or Cannot

tell (no record), and note the evidence.
• Report the share of items rated Met for each criterion, not a single score, and show how many were Cannot tell.
• Two reviewers rate independently and then reconcile. The criteria and the rating rules are agreed and published before any item is reviewed.
• Classify each item first (question, request for information, records request, suggestion, complaint) because the reasonable response differs, and note repeats and follow-ups.
• Use all resident correspondence for a fixed period (for example 1 January to 31 August 2026), drawn from the manager's records, and not one sender's. The author's items are included on the same basis and are rated by others.
• Work from de-identified copies. Leave out anything personal, medical or in legal dispute.
• Also note where the sending could be improved: one topic per message, a clear ask, a reasonable response time, and a single address. The review should show what makes a message easy to answer.
6. Testing the perception of a hold on the Committee
1. Fill the record gaps. Ask Grady Strata, directly or through the existing section 120A request, for the nomination forms and dates for each AGM since 2020, the 2026 count for each candidate and round, and the number of lots eligible to vote.
2. A de-identified profile from Grady. Counts only: owner-occupied and investor-owned lots, and years since purchase in bands. Compare them with the lots that attend and serve, with Grady or the Secretary doing the matching and reporting group totals only. Do not report any group under five.
3. A short anonymous survey of owners and residents, in plain language and translated where needed. Ask how well the Committee represents people like you, whether you have attended, voted or considered standing, what stops you, how long you have lived here, owner or renter, and (optionally) an age band and preferred language and channel. Publish the results to everyone.
4. Conversations, with consent, with former members, 2026 nominees who were not seated, regular attenders, and people in the parts of the complex with no recorded attendance.
5. Track the next cycle. Record nominations (in advance or from the floor), the method, the count, and whether newcomers who stand are appointed. Track first-time attendees' return rate and the effect of electronic voting.
Agree in advance what would count as evidence. Findings pointing to restricted access would include few or no nominees in most years, low turnover among a stable electorate, newcomers who stand not being appointed, and survey answers from newer owners and renters saying they would not be welcome. Findings pointing to a thin supply of volunteers would include unfilled vacancies, nominees who were welcomed, high resignation rates, and survey answers about time, skills and information. A small group of

willing people filling every vacancy looks the same from outside as restricted access, and only nomination data and the survey can separate the two. Both may apply.

7. Cautions

• "Long-standing owners" is a perception to test, not a label to apply. Do not sort people by age, language or background, and do not infer either from names.

• Keep lot-level analysis with the manager or the Secretary and publish group totals only. The Act limits owners' access to other owners' names and addresses (section 116).

• The 2026 AGM minutes record the owners' appreciation of members who have served over a number of years. The aim is wider participation, in addition to that service.

8. Questions for the communication group

• What would a resident who has never attended want to know before considering standing?

• How should nominations be announced so that standing is plainly open to everyone?

• What published timeframes for acknowledging and answering resident correspondence should the Committee adopt, and who should own them?

Sources

• NSW Ombudsman, Effective Complaint Management Guidelines

• NSW Ombudsman, Principle 5: Timeliness

• Standards Australia, AS 10002:2022 Guidelines for complaint management in organisations

• IPART Complaints Management Policy (example of published timeframes)

• IAP2 Spectrum of Public Participation (as applied by the City of Fort Collins)

• Australian Government Style Manual, Government writing handbook

• Unit Titles (Management) Act 2011 (ACT), ACT Legislation Register

Notes: the AS 10002:2022 text is paywalled and was not read; its acknowledgement timeframe is taken from the NSW Ombudsman's guidance, which cites it. Project sources: AGM minutes 2020 to 2026; Executive Committee minutes 2020 to 2026; 2026 AGM package; register of unanswered correspondence (31 August 2026); committee size, attendance and retention paper (31 August 2026); correspondence and committee continuity note (2 September 2026). Attendance figures are compiled by lot from the minutes and should be checked against the corporation's records.
